

STAFF REPORT

An Ordinance Amending Section 17.80.080 Regarding Signs in the P Public District

PREPARED BY: Jim Flesher, AICP, Senior Planner

MEETING October 3, 2011 – Planning Commission

DATES: October 10, 2011 – City Council (Ordinance 1st Reading)

RECOMMENDATION: The Urban Planning Office recommends adoption of an ordinance amending Section 17.80.080 of the Cheyenne City Code regarding signage.

STAFF REPORT UPDATE (10/4/11): At its regular meeting, Monday, October 3, 2011, the Cheyenne Planning Commission voted unanimously to recommend approval of the ordinance.

STAFF REPORT: The attached ordinance would repeal and re-enact Section 17.80.080 regarding signs in the P Public District. Some of changes include the following:

1. The current code limits signs in this district to 32 square feet, except for electronic message centers within 1,000 feet of an interstate, which may be up to 672 square feet. The proposal would set a limit for wall signs of 20 percent of the wall area to which the sign is attached, up to a maximum of 400 square feet, which is the limit on wall sign area in the current code for commercial and industrial zone districts. The limits for freestanding and low-profile signs would depend on the sign's distance from the right-of-way, with limits increasing as the distance from the right-of-way increases, similar to the restrictions in the commercial and industrial districts in the current code.
2. The current code limits electronic message centers in the P Public District to properties over 50 acres in size. The revision removes the 50-acre restriction, but limits electronic message centers to low-profile signs. The area of the electronic message center could be up to half the allowable area of the low-profile sign if the property is considered an entertainment venue with more than 1,000 seats. For all other properties in the P Public District, the size of the electronic message center would be limited to 15 percent of the allowable low-profile sign area.
3. Electronic message centers in the P Public District would also be limited in the ordinance by restricting the number of times the message can change in a 24-hour period to three times. Animation, video, blinking, flashing, and moving lights on an electronic message center would be prohibited. The brightness of electronic message centers would also be restricted and they would not be allowed within 150 feet of the property line of a duplex, single-family dwelling, or townhouse, similar to the restrictions on digital billboards.

Enclosed: Draft Ordinance
Copy of currently adopted Section 17.80.080
Memo from Dru Rohla, Executive Director, Cheyenne Civic Center